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The expression on the right hand side (RHS) of equation (4.12) is the change in kinetic energy (ΔKE) of the body.

This implies that *the work done by the force on the body changes the kinetic energy of the body. This is called work-kinetic energy theorem.*

The work-kinetic energy theorem implies the following.

1. If the work done by the force on the body is positive then its kinetic energy increases.
2. If the work done by the force on the body is negative then its kinetic energy decreases.
3. If there is no work done by the force on the body then there is no change in its kinetic energy, which means that the body has moved at constant speed provided its mass remains constant.

4.2.3 Relation between Momentum and Kinetic Energy

Consider an object of mass m moving with a velocity $\vec{v}$. Then its linear momentum is $\vec{p} = m\vec{v}$ and its kinetic energy, $KE = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$.

$$KE = \frac{1}{2}mv^2 = \frac{1}{2}m(\vec{v}.\vec{v}) \quad (4.13)$$

Multiplying both the numerator and denominator of equation (4.13) by mass, m

$$KE = \frac{1}{2}\frac{m^2(\vec{v}.\vec{v})}{m}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}\frac{(m\vec{v}).(m\vec{v})}{m} \quad [\vec{p} = m\vec{v}]$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}\frac{\vec{p}.\vec{p}}{m}$$

$$= \frac{p^2}{2m}$$

$$KE = \frac{p^2}{2m} \quad (4.14)$$

where $|\vec{p}|$ is the magnitude of the momentum. The magnitude of the linear momentum can be obtained by

$$|\vec{p}| = p = \sqrt{2m\,(KE)} \quad (4.15)$$

Note that if kinetic energy and mass are given, only the magnitude of the momentum can be calculated but not the direction of momentum. It is because the kinetic energy and mass are scalars.

EXAMPLE 4.7

Two objects of masses 2 kg and 4 kg are moving with the same momentum of 20 kg m s^{-1}.

(a) Will they have same kinetic energy?
(b) Will they have same speed?

Solution

(a) The kinetic energy of the mass is given by $KE = \frac{p^2}{2m}$

For the object of mass 2 kg, kinetic energy is $KE_1 = \frac{(20)^2}{2\times 2} = \frac{400}{4} = 100\,J$